

of the New York Philharmonic, with no greater success. He continued to compose on holidays in Austria, producing the song cycle *Das Lied von der Erde*, often considered his finest work, and commencing his Tenth Symphony. The premiere of his Eighth Symphony in Munich in 1910 was a triumph. But his marriage was breaking down, Alma carrying on an affair with architect Walter Gropius. In his distress, Mahler consulted the psychoanalyst Sigmund Freud, to no obvious benefit. He attempted a reconciliation with Alma, even arranging for some of her songs to be performed. When he fell mortally ill in New York in spring 1911, she accompanied him on his final journey to die in Vienna. He was buried in Grinzing Cemetery, alongside his daughter Maria.

Mahler's music went through a long period of posthumous neglect. It was banned by the Nazis as "decadent" and largely ignored by everyone else. In the 1960s, however, Mahler underwent a spectacular revival, his music attaining iconic status as part of that radical decade's heterodox cultural mix. His works have since become established as a fixture in the orchestral repertoire.